HEAVY WEATHER

A short film screenplay

A quiet story about depression, slow recovery, and friendship.

FADE IN:

INT. ELLIE'S BEDROOM - SATURDAY NOON

Curtains half-drawn. The room is in mild disarray: laundry piled on a chair, textbooks unopened on the desk. ELLIE (17) lies on top of her unmade bed, fully clothed in a grey hoodie, staring at the wall pattern. Downstairs, the front doorbell RINGS. Ellie doesn't move. A minute later, quiet footsteps come up the stairs. A knock on the door. HANNAH (17) opens the door gently. She carries two paper takeaway cups.

HANNAH

Your mom let me in.

Ellie shifts slightly, propping herself up on one elbow.

ELLIE

I forgot we were supposed to meet.

HANNAH

I know. That is why I brought the tea to you.

Hannah walks over, sets one cup on the bedside table, and sits on the floor with her back against the bed frame.

INT. ELLIE'S BEDROOM - LATER

Twenty minutes have passed. Neither has said much. The tea cups sit lukewarm. Hannah pulls a deck of cards out of her jacket pocket and begins shuffling them on the carpet.

ELLIE

I am bad company right now, Hannah. You don't have to stay.

HANNAH

I am not looking for entertainment. I am just hanging out.

Ellie looks down at her hands. Her voice is barely above a whisper.

ELLIE

It just feels heavy. Like waking up with lead weights on my chest. Every small thing takes three times as much effort.

HANNAH

Then don't do the small things today. Just sit here.

ELLIE

It has been three weeks. Everyone expects me to be over it.

HANNAH

Well, I don't. Take three months if you need to.

Ellie swallows hard. A small tear escapes her eye, but she doesn't wipe it away. Hannah lays out cards for a simple game of Rummy on the carpet. She doesn't press Ellie to join, just plays both hands slowly.

EXT. ELLIE'S BACK GARDEN - LATE AFTERNOON

The air is crisp. Clouds drift slowly over the suburban yards. Ellie and Hannah sit on the back wooden steps wearing coats. Ellie breathes in the cool breeze. It is the first time she has been outside the house in four days.

ELLIE

Thanks for coming over.

HANNAH

See you tomorrow. Same time.

Hannah gets up, gives Ellie's shoulder a firm squeeze, and walks down the driveway. Ellie remains on the step for a moment, watching the wind move through the garden trees.

THE END

FADE OUT.